thousands of war elephants awaiting their arrival on the eastern side of the Ganga River. Though the Ganga is often referred to as the Ganges, the Hindi pronunciation is, in fact, the former. Facing a renown warlord and struggling with a near mutinous army at his side, Alexander was forced to give up and abandon India altogether. He left generals in the already-conquered communities across the north, including the loyal King Porus, but personally headed back to Macedonia via Persia.

The journey home was unexpectedly fruitful, and yet nearly devastating for Alexander of Macedonia. While crossing Punjab, the retreating army, still massive in number, encountered an enemy tribe, the Malli. The Macedonian army attacked with full force against a strong and determined rival, eventually chasing the Malli to their home city. The Citadel, built upon an island within a loop of the Hydraotis River, was precarious and not easy to overtake. During the ensuing siege, Alexander himself was shot through the lung by an enemy arrow. Believing their great leader to be dead, the Macedonians fought bitterly until the city was taken and the Malli crushed under their military might. Indeed alive thanks to the administrations of his personal physician, Philip of Acarnania, Alexander claimed the city and added it to his Indian earnings before moving out with his soldiers, horses, and weaponry. He left his appointed administrators in charge to deal with tribute to the empire and never returned to India or Macedonia, dying only two years later of an unknown illness in Babylon.

With the mighty Macedonian ruler out of the picture, India quickly fell back into the hands of local rulers. It was only 322 BCE, four years after Alexander the Great had entered India from the west, when a new leader emerged to wrest control of the country out of the hands of the Greeks left behind.